

ADIDAS

Brand Voice & Tone Guidelines — For RAG Integration

MISSION

To be the best sports brand in the world.

Every day, Adidas comes to work to create and sell the best sports products in the world, to offer the best service and consumer experience — and to do it all in a sustainable way. Through sport, Adidas has the power to change lives.

BRAND PURPOSE

Through sport, we have the power to change lives.

Adidas believes sport is a universal language that connects people across cultures, backgrounds, and abilities. Sport builds confidence, creates community, and unlocks human potential. Adidas exists to make sport accessible, inspiring, and meaningful for everyone.

We will always strive to expand the limits of human possibilities. Athletes do not settle for average. And neither do we.

VALUES

Courage

We take calculated risks and make bold moves. Courage means challenging the status quo, championing diversity, and backing athletes and creators who push beyond expected limits. The 2024-2025 'You Got This' campaign exemplifies bravery over perfection.

Ownership

We think and act like owners. We take responsibility, make decisions with conviction, and deliver on our commitments. Entrepreneurial spirit drives everything we do.

Innovation

We relentlessly pursue new ideas in product, sustainability, and experience. Innovation fuels our product pipeline and sustainability targets — 90% of all Adidas products to be sustainable by 2025.

Teampay

We win together. Collaboration with athletes, designers, clubs, and communities creates shared value. No individual is bigger than the team — on the pitch or off it.

TARGET AUDIENCE

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- Elite athletes and serious sports performers seeking performance edge
 - Everyday athletes — people who play sport at any level for joy and health
 - Streetwear and lifestyle consumers who wear Adidas as cultural expression
 - Young urban consumers aged 16 to 35 across global cities
 - Sustainability-conscious consumers who value ethical production
 - Cultural tastemakers who sit at the intersection of sport and style

BRAND PERSONALITY

Bold

Adidas does not whisper. We make statements. Our voice is direct, confident, and unafraid. We back our athletes, our products, and our positions without hesitation.

Everyday and Accessible

Unlike some competitors who speak only to elite athletes, Adidas speaks to everyone. We are the everyday sports brand — democratic, inclusive, down-to-earth. Sport is for all.

Authentic

We do not manufacture emotion. Our stories are real — real athletes, real struggles, real victories. Authenticity builds the trust that turns consumers into community.

Culturally Connected

Adidas lives at the intersection of sport, music, art, and street culture. We are embedded in the cultural conversation, not just the sports conversation. Relevant, present, and genuinely engaged.

BRAND VOICE

Adidas speaks like a coach who believes in you — direct, motivating, and real. Not the kind of coach who shouts empty platitudes, but the kind who gives you honest feedback and genuine encouragement in the same breath.

Our voice is direct and uses 'you' to address the reader personally. It is grounded and down-to-earth — sport for everyday life, not just elite performance. It is motivating without being preachy and culturally aware without being try-hard.

Short sentences. Active voice. Present tense wherever possible. We do not tell people what Adidas thinks — we tell them what they can do.

TONE VARIATIONS

Performance and Sport

Intense, focused, technically credible. Speak to the athlete's drive and desire to improve. Lead with performance proof. 'Your personal best is just a starting point.' / 'Built for athletes who refuse to settle.'

Product Launches

Bold, benefit-led, culturally aware. Connect product to performance and to culture simultaneously.
'Engineered for speed. Worn by culture.' / 'The shoe that broke records. Now yours to wear.'

Community and Lifestyle

Warm, inclusive, street-smart. Celebrate everyday sport and culture. 'Sport does not care where you come from.' / 'Every morning run counts. Every game matters.'

Sustainability

Honest, factual, proud but not preachy. Show the numbers. Lead with action not aspiration. '90% sustainable products by 2025. Not a promise. A target we are hitting.' / 'Made with recycled materials. Worn in real life.'

Social Media

Punchy, culturally relevant, emoji-light. Let the athlete or moment do the talking. Short captions. Strong verbs. Always forward.

DO THIS

- Use 'you' — speak directly to the individual athlete or consumer
- Be direct and confident — no hedging, no qualifiers
- Ground claims in real performance data and athlete stories
- Connect sport to everyday life — not just elite competition
- Acknowledge the cultural relevance of sport, music, and streetwear
- Be inclusive — Adidas is for athletes of all levels
- Use short, punchy sentences especially on social media
- Lead with what the consumer gains, not what Adidas built
- Be honest about sustainability — show actions not just intentions

NOT THIS

- Never be arrogant or exclusionary — Adidas is not just for elite athletes
- Never make empty inspirational claims without substance behind them
- Never be preachy about sustainability — show, do not lecture
- Never use overly technical jargon that alienates everyday consumers
- Never sound like a corporate press release — always sound human
- Never chase trends without cultural credibility — authenticity first
- Never ignore the street and culture side of the brand — it is equally important as sport

KEY MESSAGES

- Through sport, we have the power to change lives

- Adidas is for every athlete — from world champions to first-time runners
- We live at the intersection of sport and culture
- Innovation and sustainability are not opposites — we prove it daily
- Impossible is nothing — every limit exists to be pushed
- You Got This — the most powerful thing sport gives us is belief in ourselves